# Five-note foundations

Name _____ Date _____ BPM _____

Ready? Find C and use finger numbers 1–5 with a comfortable hand.

Goal: Keep a steady pulse and release freely.

Start around 40–60 quarter-note beats/minute, or slower. Count 1–2–3–4; each row is two bars. Hands separately first. Rest after each attempt; stop if pain or tension appears. No forced finger lifting.

## 1. Even steps

Play one quarter note per beat. First sing, then play right hand alone.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | D4 | E4 | F4 | G4 | F4 | E4 | D4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 2. Return to home

Play softly, then moderately. Keep the beat unchanged.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | D4 | E4 | D4 | C4 | D4 | E4 | C4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 3. Touch contrast

Play connected, then detached. Leave silence after the final note.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | E4 | D4 | F4 | E4 | D4 | C4 | C4 |
| Finger | 1 | 3 | 2 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 4. Make music

Invent a four-note answer using C–G. Circle the note your phrase moves toward.

My phrase / fingering: _____

Ready to progress: Two steady, comfortable repetitions with an audible difference between connected and detached touch. □ With help □ Independently □ Revisit

What improved? _____ Next small goal _____

Hanon context and original score links: lessons/music/instruments/piano.html#piano-worksheets

# Hanon-style sequences

Name _____ Date _____ BPM _____

Ready? Play five-note patterns evenly without holding tension.

Goal: Move a small pattern by step; listen for evenness, not speed.

Start around 40–60 quarter-note beats/minute, or slower. Count 1–2–3–4; each row is two bars. Hands separately first. Rest after each attempt; stop if pain or tension appears. No forced finger lifting.

## 1. A repeating cell

Right hand alone. This classroom cell uses the opening contour of Hanon No. 1; it is not the complete exercise.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | E4 | F4 | G4 | A4 | G4 | F4 | E4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 2. Move one step

Shift the whole hand. Alternate this cell with the first; rest between cells before joining.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | D4 | F4 | G4 | A4 | B4 | A4 | G4 | F4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 3. Reverse the contour

An adapted descending cell. Play quarter notes first; later try two even eighth notes per beat.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | A4 | F4 | E4 | D4 | C4 | D4 | E4 | F4 |
| Finger | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 4. Make music

Shape each cell toward its highest note, then try the same direction in two bars of your piece.

My phrase / fingering: _____

Ready to progress: Join two cells evenly, release comfortably, and describe one change in sound. □ With help □ Independently □ Revisit

What improved? _____ Next small goal _____

Hanon context and original score links: lessons/music/instruments/piano.html#piano-worksheets

# Scales & arpeggios

Name _____ Date _____ BPM _____

Ready? Move between positions comfortably; learn crossings with a teacher if needed.

Goal: Coordinate travel without an accented thumb.

Start around 40–60 quarter-note beats/minute, or slower. Count 1–2–3–4; each row is two bars. Hands separately first. Rest after each attempt; stop if pain or tension appears. No forced finger lifting.

## 1. C major up

Right hand. Play one note per beat; isolate E–F before joining. Reverse notes and fingering to descend.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | D4 | E4 | F4 | G4 | A4 | B4 | C5 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 2. C major left hand

Left hand alone, one note per beat. Isolate G–A. The bass-register note names below specify the intended octave.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C3 | D3 | E3 | F3 | G3 | A3 | B3 | C4 |
| Finger | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 3. Broken triad

Right hand, one note per beat. Move the arm with the hand. Use C–E–G only if an octave is uncomfortable.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | E4 | G4 | C5 | G4 | E4 | C4 | C4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 4. Make music

Find a scale fragment or broken chord in your piece. Mark a practical fingering and practice only that fragment.

My phrase / fingering: _____

Ready to progress: An even crossing at a comfortable tempo and the same movement applied to a musical phrase. □ With help □ Independently □ Revisit

What improved? _____ Next small goal _____

Hanon context and original score links: lessons/music/instruments/piano.html#piano-worksheets

# Balance & musical control

Name _____ Date _____ BPM _____

Ready? Play a short melody steadily and coordinate a held bass note.

Goal: Control phrase direction and accompaniment balance.

Start around 40–60 quarter-note beats/minute, or slower. Count 1–2–3–4; each row is two bars. Hands separately first. Rest after each attempt; stop if pain or tension appears. No forced finger lifting.

## 1. A singing phrase

Right hand, one note per beat. Sing first; choose a destination and ease away afterward.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | D4 | E4 | G4 | A4 | G4 | E4 | C4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 2. Quiet bass, clear melody

Right hand quarter notes. Left hand holds C3 with finger 5 for each four-beat bar. Keep bass quieter.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | E4 | G4 | E4 | D4 | C4 | D4 | E4 | C4 |
| Finger | 3 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 3. Chord travel

Right hand quarter notes: one bar of C harmony, then F. Practice without pedal; optionally add a clean pedal change at F.

Notes and suggested finger numbers · 1 = thumb, 5 = little finger

| Count | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note | C4 | E4 | G4 | E4 | C4 | F4 | A4 | F4 |
| Finger | 1 | 2 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 5 | 3 |

Comfortable, accurate repeats: □ □ □ Listen for _____

## 4. Make music

Play two bars of repertoire twice: first equal loudness, then a clear melody over quieter accompaniment. Describe the difference.

My phrase / fingering: _____

Ready to progress: A listener can hear phrase direction and a quieter bass without loss of pulse. □ With help □ Independently □ Revisit

What improved? _____ Next small goal _____

Hanon context and original score links: lessons/music/instruments/piano.html#piano-worksheets